

LRWC 2003 Annual Report Letters for Lawyers 10 which he represented the children of political activists who were murdered in 1998, allegedly by officials of the Ministry of Intelligence. Mr. Zarafshan had criticized the manner in which these murders had been investigated, including the absence of important information from court files. Qasem Sho'leh Sa'di, lawyer On February 24, 2003, Qasem Sho'leh Sa'di, a lawyer and political science professor at Tehran University, was arrested on his return to Iran after a visit to France. Qasem Sho'leh Sa'di had published an open letter addressed to the Leader of Iran on December 6, 2002. The letter, which respectfully questioned the basis of the Leader's position and criticized a range of the Leader's policies, was published on the writer's own website. Amnesty international fears that Mr. Sa'di, whose lawyer was not permitted to meet him, may be facing torture or ill treatment in incommunicado detention. 11. LIBERIA Tiawon Gongloe, lawyer Tiawon Gongloe, a leading Liberian human rights lawyer, was arrested without charges on April 24, 2002, and believed to have been beaten while in custody. Amnesty International believes that his treatment was precipitated solely by his human rights advocacy. Tiawon Gongloe was discharged from hospital on May 1, 2002. The police put him in the charge of Archbishop Michael Francis, a prominent advocate of human rights and he was subsequently hospitalized for the injuries he received while in custody. Dato Param Kumaraswamy, UN Special Rapporteur on the Independence of Judges and Lawyers has advised that Liberian lawyers are in need of assistance. 12. MEXICO Sergio Dante Amaraz, lawyer Sergio Dante Amaraz, who represents one of two men accused of the murder of eight young women in Ciudad Jurarez, is believed to be in danger because of his involvement with this case. Before being arrested by the police, the two men subsequently charged were kidnapped and tortured to confess to the killings. One of the accused was later found murdered in his cell. On February 2, 2002, Mario Escolbedo Anaya, the lawyer for the murdered accused, was shot dead by state police who have since claimed self-defence saying the lawyer fired first. The Inter-American Commission on Human Rights has issued protective measures on behalf of Sergio Dante Amaraz and Miriam Garcia, the wife of the surviving accused. Despite these protection measures Miriam Garcia was threatened with death by men who broke into her home. Ernesto Ledesma Arronte, human rights defender LRWC received information that Ernesto Ledesma Arronte, director of the Centre for Political Analysis and Social and Economic Research (CAPISE) received a death threat by phone and was subjected to two break-ins: one to his home and the other to the CAPISE office. Mr. Arronte is a human rights advocate in the state of Chiapas, Mexico. He has been active in denouncing human rights violations alleged to have been committed by both armed forces and paramilitary groups. Arturo Requenses Galnares, human rights defender Arturo Requenses Galnares, a human rights defender working with Christian Action for the Abolition of Torture (Acción de los Cristianos para la Abolición de la Tortura - ACAT), was reported to have been under surveillance on July 16, 2002 and to have received a threatening phone call on July 17, 2002. Mr. Galnares had been working on a number of politically sensitive cases for ACAT, including several cases involving torture and a possible disappearance. On October 12, 2002, Director General of Human Rights for the Federal District of Mexico City replied to LRWC's letter advising that an investigation into the matter had been concluded, Mr. Galnares was safe and Attorney General Bernardo Bátiz Vázquez was committed to complying strictly with human rights. Samuel Alfonso Castellanos Pinon, lawyer Samuel Alfonso Castellanos Pinon, a lawyer acting on behalf of those accused of the Agua Fria killings, received an anonymous death threat. The written threat warned Mr. Pinon that he would be killed unless he stopped representing the accused. A similar threat had been made earlier against members of Christian Action for the Abolition of Torture (ACAT) and